

3.3.3 The concept of quality

Content	Additional information
Consequences of quality issues	Students should have an understanding of customer expectations of quality in terms of production of goods and the provision of services. How businesses identify quality problems and how businesses measure quality and the consequences of these issues.

Content	Additional information
Methods of maintaining consistent quality: Total quality management (TQM)	Students should be aware of the methods of maintaining consistent quality and be able to identify the advantages to a business of using TQM.
Costs and benefits of maintaining quality: • additional sales • image/reputation • higher price • inspection costs • staff training • product recalls • the provision of services.	Students should be aware of the possible quality issues as businesses grow, particularly if outsourcing and franchising is used.